

SiyaBusa ERP

EMAIL COMMUNICATION POLICY

Brand & Corporate Documentation

Masaphokati Technologies (Pty) Ltd

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Department: Operations

Classification: Internal

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Email Communication Policy

COMMUNICATION POLICY

Standards for professional email communications on behalf of Masaphokati Technologies.

1. Purpose

This policy establishes standards for all email communications sent on behalf of Masaphokati Technologies (Pty) Ltd and SiyaBusa ERP. It ensures consistency, professionalism, and compliance with applicable regulations.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All employees and contractors
 - All business email communications
 - Marketing emails and newsletters
 - Transactional emails (invoices, receipts, notifications)
 - Support communications
 - Internal company emails
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3. Email Signature Standards

3.1 Standard Email Signature

All business emails must include a professional signature:

```
[Full Name]
[Job Title] | Masaphokati Technologies

[email]@siyabusa.co.za
[phone number]
```

siyabusa.co.za

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This email and any attachments are confidential and intended solely for the addressee. If you received this in error, please delete it and notify the sender.

3.2 Signature Elements

Element	Required	Notes
Full name	Yes	As registered in HR
Job title	Yes	Official title only
Company name	Yes	"Masaphokati Technologies"
Email	Yes	Company email only
Phone	Optional	Work number preferred
Website	Yes	siyabusa.co.za
Tagline	Yes	Brand tagline
Confidentiality notice	Yes	Required for external emails

3.3 Prohibited in Signatures

- Personal quotes or sayings
 - Political statements
 - Religious content
 - Animated GIFs
 - Large images (>50KB)
 - Personal social media links
 - Unauthorized logos or badges
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4. Professional Email Standards

4.1 Subject Lines

Do	Don't
Be specific and descriptive	Use vague subjects like "Hello" or "Question"
Include reference numbers when relevant	Leave subject blank
Keep under 60 characters	Use ALL CAPS
Indicate urgency appropriately	Mark everything as urgent

Good examples:

- "Invoice #1234 - January 2026"
- "SiyaBusa ERP: Your trial expires in 3 days"
- "Meeting request: Q1 Planning - Jan 15"

4.2 Email Body

Opening:

- Use professional greetings: "Dear [Name]," or "Hello [Name],"
- Avoid overly casual: "Hey" or "Yo"

Body:

- Get to the point quickly
- Use short paragraphs (3-4 sentences max)
- Use bullet points for lists
- One topic per email when possible

Closing:

- Professional sign-offs: "Kind regards," "Best regards," "Thank you,"
- Avoid: "Cheers," "Later," "TTYL"

4.3 Tone and Language

Do	Don't
Be professional and courteous	Be overly casual or use slang

Do	Don't
Proofread before sending	Send with typos or errors
Use proper grammar	Use text speak (u, ur, thx)
Be concise	Write unnecessarily long emails
Respond within 24 business hours	Leave emails unanswered

5. Email Types and Standards

5.1 Marketing Emails

Requirements:

- Clear sender identification (Masaphokati Technologies / SiyaBusa ERP)
- Physical address in footer
- Unsubscribe link (one-click)
- Compliance with POPIA and CAN-SPAM

Template elements:

- Header with logo
- Clear value proposition
- Single call-to-action
- Footer with contact info and unsubscribe

5.2 Transactional Emails

Types:

- Account confirmations
- Password resets
- Invoice/receipt notifications
- System alerts
- Support ticket updates

Requirements:

- Immediate delivery

- Clear subject indicating purpose
- No promotional content (keeps deliverability high)
- Reply-to address that is monitored

5.3 Support Emails

Standards:

- Acknowledge receipt within 4 hours (business hours)
- Include ticket/reference number
- Set clear expectations for resolution time
- Follow up until resolved
- Request feedback after closure

5.4 Internal Emails

Guidelines:

- Use appropriate distribution lists
- Don't "Reply All" unless necessary
- Mark confidential information clearly
- Use @mentions for specific attention needed

6. Confidentiality and Security

6.1 Confidential Information

- Never send passwords via email
- Use secure file sharing for sensitive documents
- Encrypt attachments containing personal data
- Verify recipient before sending confidential information

6.2 Data Protection (POPIA Compliance)

- Only collect email addresses with consent
- Honor unsubscribe requests within 5 business days
- Never share customer email lists
- Include privacy policy link in marketing emails

- Retain email records per retention policy

6.3 Phishing Prevention

- Never click suspicious links
 - Verify unusual requests via phone
 - Report suspected phishing to IT immediately
 - Don't forward suspicious emails
-

7. Email Lists and Newsletters

7.1 Subscription Management

- Double opt-in required for marketing lists
- Clear description of what subscribers will receive
- Easy unsubscribe process
- Segment lists appropriately

7.2 Frequency Guidelines

List Type	Frequency
Newsletter	Monthly
Product updates	As needed (max weekly)
Promotional	Max 2 per month
Transactional	As triggered

7.3 Content Standards

- Valuable, relevant content
 - Mobile-responsive design
 - Clear calls-to-action
 - Proper alt-text for images
 - Plain text version available
-

8. Response Time Standards

Email Type	Response Time
Customer support	Within 4 business hours
Sales inquiries	Within 2 business hours
Partner communications	Within 24 business hours
Internal emails	Within 24 business hours
Urgent (marked)	Within 1 business hour

9. Out-of-Office Messages

9.1 Required Elements

Thank you for your email.

I am currently out of the office from [date] to [date] with limited access to email.

For urgent matters, please contact [Name] at [email].

I will respond to your email upon my return.

Kind regards,
[Your Name]
Masaphokati Technologies

9.2 Guidelines

- Set before leaving
 - Include return date
 - Provide alternative contact for urgent matters
 - Keep message professional and brief
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10. Prohibited Email Practices

The following are strictly prohibited:

1. **Personal use** of company email for non-work purposes
 2. **Forwarding** company emails to personal accounts
 3. **Sending** offensive, discriminatory, or harassing content
 4. **Sharing** confidential information without authorization
 5. **Mass emailing** without approval from marketing
 6. **Impersonating** another employee or entity
 7. **Subscribing** company emails to external lists without approval
 8. **Auto-forwarding** to external addresses
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11. Email Retention

Email Type	Retention Period
General correspondence	3 years
Financial/contractual	7 years
Legal matters	Permanent (or as advised)
Marketing campaigns	3 years
Support tickets	5 years

12. Enforcement

Violations of this policy may result in:

- Verbal warning
 - Written warning
 - Suspension of email privileges
 - Disciplinary action up to termination
 - Legal action if applicable
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13. Policy Review

This policy is reviewed annually and updated as needed. Employees will be notified of significant changes.

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Document Classification: Internal

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